

FROM AMBER TO 5× · 16 JULY – 30 SEPTEMBER MMXXVI

A programme to turn the audit's findings into an operating layer that measures itself, runs from a register instead of a memory, and reaches the doctrine's 5× leverage — built control-plane first, in four phases, with an owner and a done-when on every line.

Build the control plane first.

Three volumes of Lightspeed reached the same verdict: **AMBER**. The daily briefing machine is dependable and, in July, prolific — 362 artifacts in a fortnight. But it is a cockpit, not a control plane. It cannot run a weekly operating review from data, it stopped measuring itself after 3 July, and the one operator it exists to relieve is still the hidden integrator. The Operating Doctrine's standing instruction is unambiguous: *"Build the control plane first. Without it, every other layer turns into clever chaos."* This plan follows that instruction to the letter.

The work is organised into **four phases across eleven weeks**, from 16 July to the doctrine's **30 September** leverage deadline. Phase 0 makes the machine tell the truth about itself. Phase 1 builds the canonical matter registry — the single load-bearing artefact everything else hangs from. Phase 2 adds routing, the first playbooks and the governance the Stella incidents demand. Phase 3 deploys the six monitors, renders the registry live on the dashboard the team already uses — **Notion is retired; you don't use it** — and measures the move from **2.8x to 5x**. Each phase has an exit gate; nothing advances until the gate is met.

4	8	2.8 → 5x	30 Sep
PHASES · 11 WEEKS	FINDINGS → FIXES	LEVERAGE TARGET	GREEN BY
Stabilise · Control plane · Routing & playbooks · Monitors & scale.	Every AMBER gap mapped to an owned, dated remedy.	Machine multiplier by 30 Sep, per Doctrine v1.0.	The scorecard crosses from AMBER to GREEN on every line.

THE ONE-SENTENCE THESIS

Stop adding briefings. Build the register, make the telemetry honest, wire routing and monitors on top of it, and hold the whole thing to a scorecard — so the firm can be run from a system instead of from one person's memory.

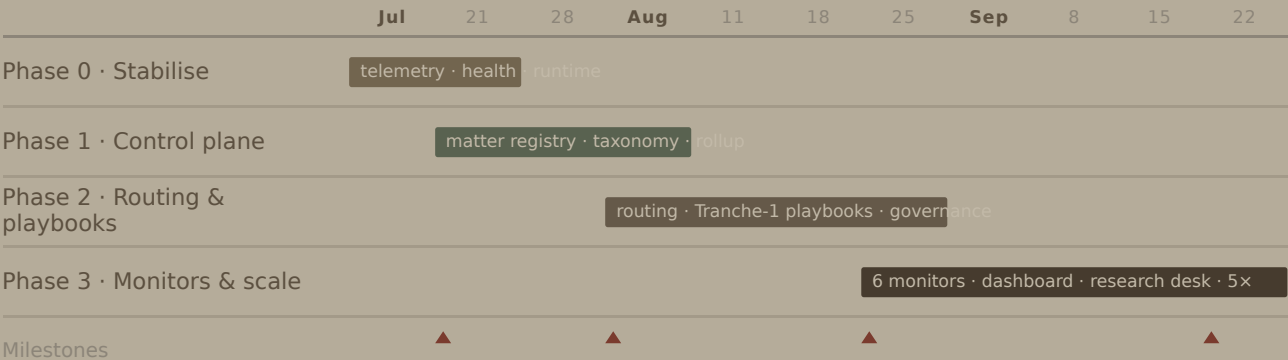
The eight findings, the eight fixes.

Every AMBER gap from the audit, mapped to a remedy, a phase and an owner.

FINDING (AUDIT)	FIX	PHASE	OWNER
No control plane — no matter registry; 02-index / 06-governance are empty shells.	Build the canonical matter registry (11 fields), taxonomy and risk/value matrix; stamp matter IDs on every output.	1	Farhad · Brandon
Telemetry went dark — flat 0.0/min then nothing after 3 Jul; errors_today hard-coded 0; no token/cost.	Restore the pipeline counter; compute errors from the log; add per-service health; add token & dollar usage.	0	Infra
No home for structured state — the Notion migration was abandoned and is unused; nothing renders live state.	Retire Notion. The file-based registry in Dropbox is the single source of truth, rendered live on the dashboard.	1→3	Farhad · Zach
Audit substrate regressed — event sidecars counts-only since 28 Apr; scorecard uncomputable.	Restore the rich events.json schema (fact / risk / monitor / opportunity registries).	0	Infra
Inference fragile — Ollama timeouts (79 conn / 27 t/o); gemma fallback noise; sheba has no endpoint; port 8787 collides with Octogent.	Harden Ollama (retry/queue); give sheba a real endpoint or retire it; resolve the port collision; suppress fallback noise.	0	Infra
Runtime EOL — Python 3.9.6 past support; 2 failing date-fixture tests.	Migrate to Python 3.12; fix the date-fixture tests; green the suite in CI.	0→1	Infra
Trust & governance — briefed Hyperion wrong; Stella disclosed data to a third party; "over-caffeinated AI."	Confirmation gates on external actions; Stella data-handling guardrails; IPP 3A review; human-sets-strategy rule.	2	Farhad · Counsel
Surge shallow — no new research brief after 11 Jun; renders asserted, not filed.	Restore research-desk cadence with cost caps; make claimed deliverables land as files, or stop claiming them.	3	Zach

The roadmap.

Four phases, eleven weeks, one deadline — 30 September.



PHASE 0

Stabilise & tell the truth. Wk 1. The machine must measure itself before it scales. Exit: telemetry honest, suite green.

PHASE 1

The control plane. Wk 2-4. One canonical registry, populated. Exit: every live matter has a row and an ID.

PHASE 2

Routing, playbooks, governance. Wk 4-8. Decisions get routed; the risky ones escalate. Exit: 3 playbooks live.

PHASE 3

Monitors & scale. Wk 8-11. Six monitors, dashboard live, 5× measured. Exit: scorecard GREEN.

PHASE 0 · WEEK 1 · 16-25 JULY

Stabilise & tell the truth.

A machine that cannot see itself cannot be scaled. Fix the instruments first.

0.1 · Honest telemetry

Infra

Restore the pipeline counter that went silent after 3 July. Replace the hard-coded `errors_today = 0` with a real count off `daily/_errors`. Add per-service health (citadel-intel, Ollama primary + fallback, Gmail, Calendar, note-router, sheba) and per-run token & dollar usage.

Done when: every digest carries a live telemetry block with real error counts, per-service status, and token/\$ for the day.

0.2 · Harden inference

Infra

Wrap Ollama calls in `retry-with-backoff` and a small queue so a timeout degrades gracefully instead of dropping to gemma noise. Resolve the port-8787 collision with the Octogent SSH listener. Give *sheba* a real health endpoint or formally retire the node.

Done when: a week passes with zero unhandled Ollama timeouts and no "sheba unreachable" phantom.

0.3 · Restore the audit substrate

Infra

Bring back the rich events `.json` schema retired on 28 April — the fact, risk, monitor-hit and opportunity registries — so the forensic scorecard can be computed from data rather than re-read from prose.

Done when: a day's scorecard can be generated from sidecar data with no manual reading.

0.4 · Runtime & CI

Infra

Migrate off end-of-life Python 3.9.6 to 3.12; clear the Google-library and urllib3 deprecations; fix the two date-fixture tests so the Briefing-Room suite is green in CI.

Done when: 3.12 in production and the test suite passes 145 / 0 / 0.

EXIT GATE · PHASE 0

The dashboard reports true error counts, real per-service health and token/dollar usage; inference no longer silently falls back; the runtime is supported and the suite is green. Only then does Phase 1 begin.

PHASE 1 · WEEKS 2-4 · 26 JUL - 15 AUG

The control plane.

One canonical matter registry — the artefact everything else hangs from.

1.1 · The matter registry

Farhad ·
Brandon

Build the single source of truth the doctrine mandates: one row per live matter, eleven fields — Matter ID, category, stage, risk tier, value tier, deadline (NZT), next action, routing rule, source-of-truth link, human owner, automation coverage. It is a versioned file in Dropbox — the surface the whole system already runs on — not a briefing, and not Notion.

Done when: every live matter across all projects and fronts has a row; nothing lives only in an inbox or a head.

1.2 · Taxonomy & risk/value matrix

Farhad

A fixed category taxonomy (project / tax / litigation / finance / regulatory / entity / acquisition) and a risk×value matrix so triage is rule-based, not vibe-based. This is what lets the routing engine in Phase 2 decide anything.

Done when: every registry row carries a taxonomy tag and a risk/value cell.

1.3 · Matter IDs on every output

Infra ·
Zach

Stamp the registry's matter IDs onto daily briefings, event sidecars and captures, so a line in a digest links back to a canonical matter — the end of "which McLean's thing is this?"

Done when: briefing line items resolve to a matter ID and back to the registry.

1.4 · The weekly rollup

Farhad · Brandon

A Monday operating review generated *from the registry* — what moved, what is overdue, what is at risk, what needs a decision — replacing the memory-based Monday.

Done when: the first registry-driven weekly rollup runs and is used to run the week.

THE ELEVEN FIELDS

- Matter ID
- Category (taxonomy)
- Stage
- Risk tier
- Value tier
- Deadline (NZT)
- Next action
- Routing rule
- Source-of-truth link
- Human owner
- Automation coverage

SEED SET · DAY ONE

Backfill from what the reports already surfaced: Hyperion DOCA, the NOPA entities, ERA 3407924, Police v Moinfar, McLeans, RYU Albany, Babich Rise, 126 Featherston, Castra suite, the SPV register, the acquisition pipeline. ~40 live matters exist today — none are in a registry.

WHY THIS IS LOAD-BEARING

Without it the machine can brief and remind but cannot run a review, route a decision, or catch a slipping matter. It is the difference between a cockpit and a control plane — and the doctrine's first instruction.

PHASE 2 · WEEKS 4-8 · 11 AUG - 5 SEP

Routing, playbooks & governance.

Decisions get routed; the risky ones escalate to a human; the machine gets guardrails.

2.1 · The routing engine

Infra · Farhad

Four hard paths on every registry item — *auto-execute* · *draft-for-review* · *escalate-to-human* · *route-external* — with mandatory escalation triggers (see facing page). The machine stops deciding what only a human should.

Done when: each registry row resolves to one of four routes, and every escalation trigger fires a human review.

2.2 · Tranche-1 playbooks

Farhad · Brandon

The three highest-frequency six-component playbooks the doctrine names: **IRD / Authority, Property Transaction**, and **Finance Application** — each a repeatable sequence the machine can drive and a human can sign.

Done when: a live matter in each class is run end-to-end through its playbook.

2.3 · Stella guardrails & privacy

Farhad · Counsel

Confirmation gates before any external send or disclosure; a deny-list on financial/calendar detail after the June data-disclosure incident; the IPP 3A / Privacy Act review the three production agents still need.

Done when: no agent can send or disclose externally without a gate, and the privacy review is signed off.

MANDATORY ESCALATION TRIGGERS

ESCALATE	Any contact with a regulator (IRD, ERA, Police, Councils, Commissioners).
ESCALATE	Any exposure or commitment over \$100k .
ESCALATE	Any police, court or statutory-demand matter.
ESCALATE	Any settlement or admission of liability.
EXTERNAL	Any indemnity over \$50k → external counsel review.

THE TRUST RULE, WRITTEN DOWN

The machine surfaces; counsel and the operator decide. After the "over-caffeinated AI" episode and the Hyperion mis-brief, this is doctrine, not preference: **no AI-set strategy on any live legal or financial matter.**

PHASE 3 · WEEKS 8-11 · 1 - 30 SEPTEMBER

Monitors & scale to 5x.

Autonomous watchers on top of the registry; structured state live; leverage measured.

3.1 · The six monitors

Infra · Zach

Deploy the doctrine's six autonomous monitors against the registry — **Project Pulse first**, the one that would have caught seven weeks of Trojan slippage. Then Deal Flow, Gazette, Counterparty, Obligation and Inbox Sentiment.

Done when: all six emit daily to the dashboard, and Project Pulse flags any matter unmoved past its SLA.

3.2 · Structured state — on the dashboard

Farhad · Zach

Notion is retired — the team doesn't use it, and the doctrine's "structured state → Notion wins" rule is struck. Structured state lives as files in Dropbox and **renders live on the tailnet dashboard** already in production (8787): matters, deadlines, risk, owner and next action on one screen.

Done when: the dashboard shows current registry state end-to-end, with no dependency on Notion.

3.3 · Research desk, back on cadence

Zach

Restart the Perplexity → reviewer pipeline that went quiet after 11 June, with a per-brief cost cap and the ship/revise/reject gate intact. Make claimed deliverables land as files, or stop claiming them in digests.

Done when: briefs resume on a set cadence with logged cost, and every claimed artifact is a file on the drive.

THE 5x ARITHMETIC

Baseline (March audit): ~2.8x multiplier, ~15% automation coverage. Target: **5.0x**, 65%+ coverage. The lever is not more briefings — it is routing (auto-execute the safe, draft the routine) and playbooks (repeat the known). Coverage is measured off the registry's *automation coverage* field.

MONITORS, IN PRIORITY ORDER

1. **Project Pulse** — slippage
2. Obligation — deadlines & payments
3. Gazette / Regulatory
4. Counterparty intelligence
5. Deal Flow
6. Inbox Sentiment

EXIT GATE · PHASE 3 — GREEN

Six monitors live, the registry on the dashboard, research desk on cadence with cost telemetry, and the scorecard reading GREEN across every line. Leverage at or above 5x.

The scorecard · AMBER → GREEN.

The definition of done, area by area. The plan is finished when every line is green.

Area	NOW	TARGET	Green means
Daily cadence	GREEN	GREEN	Already dependable; keep the streak, add matter IDs.
Telemetry integrity	RED	GREEN	Live counter, real errors, per-service health, token/\$.
Control plane	RED	GREEN	Registry populated; every matter has a row and ID.
Routing & playbooks	AMBER	GREEN	4 routes live; 3 Tranche-1 playbooks run end-to-end.
Monitors	AMBER	GREEN	All six deployed; Project Pulse catching slippage.
Structured state & dashboard	RED	GREEN	Registry renders live on the dashboard; Notion retired.
Governance & privacy	AMBER	GREEN	Confirmation gates live; IPP 3A review signed.
Runtime & CI	AMBER	GREEN	Python 3.12; suite 145 / 0 / 0.
Leverage	2.8×	5.0×	Measured off automation-coverage; 65%+ coverage.

THE FOUR NORTH-STAR METRICS

Machine multiplier (→ 5×) · automation coverage (→ 65%+) · matters-on-registry (→ 100%) · escalations-honoured (→ 100% of triggers routed to a human). Reported weekly, off the registry, from Phase 1 onward.

Who owns what — and what could derail it.

Accountability on every workstream; an honest read on the risks to the plan itself.

OWNERSHIP · RACI

WORKSTREAM	FARHAD	BRANDON	ZACH	INFRA	COUNSEL
Telemetry & runtime	A	.	.	R	.
Matter registry	R	A	C	C	.
Taxonomy / risk matrix	R	C	.	.	C
Routing engine	A	C	.	R	.
Playbooks (Tranche 1)	A	R	C	C	C
Governance & privacy	R	.	.	C	A
Monitors	A	.	R	R	.
Dashboard / structured state	A	.	R	C	.
Research desk	A	.	R	C	.

R responsible · A accountable · C consulted. "Infra" is the technical build owner (internal or contracted).

RISKS TO THE PLAN

HIGH

Operator bandwidth. The same person runs the deals and the build. If deal-tempo spikes, the registry slips.
Mitigant: time-box Phase 1 to the registry only; defer everything else.

HIGH

Registry rot. A registry no one updates is a dead database all over again.
Mitigant: the weekly rollup reads from it, so it must be current to be useful.

MED

Infra capacity. Phase 0 needs real engineering.
Mitigant: scope it to one week; contract if internal capacity is short.

MED

Scope creep into "more AI."
Mitigant: the exit gates — nothing new until the gate is met.

This week — the first ten actions.

The plan is only real if it starts. Ten things to do in the next seven days.

01	Un-hard-code the error count. Compute errors_today from daily/_errors; ship it in tonight's digest.	Infra
02	Restore the pipeline counter so telemetry stops reading "unavailable." Back to a live reading every evening.	Infra
03	Resolve the port-8787 collision with Octogent; confirm the dashboard serves cleanly on the tailnet.	Infra
04	Create the registry file — the eleven columns, empty — in Dropbox (Markdown + JSON). Just the skeleton. No Notion.	Farhad
05	Seed the ~40 live matters from the last three volumes into the registry — Hyperion, NOPA, ERA, Police, the four projects, Castra, the SPVs, the pipeline.	Farhad · Brandon
06	Assign an owner and a next-action to every seeded row. No orphans.	Farhad
07	Write the five escalation triggers into a one-page policy and circulate — regulator, >\$100k, police/court, settlement, >\$50k indemnity.	Farhad · Counsel
08	Put a confirmation gate on Stella's external sends after the disclosure incident — no external send or disclosure without a human OK.	Infra · Farhad
09	Kick off the Python 3.12 migration and fix the two failing date-fixture tests.	Infra
10	Run the first registry-driven Monday rollup next Monday — what moved, what's overdue, what's at risk.	Farhad · Brandon

LIGHTSPEED

Implementation Plan — From AMBER to 5×. A four-phase programme, 16 July to 30 September 2026, to build the control plane the doctrine asked for first.

Derived from the recommendations and gaps in Lightspeed Volumes One to Three and the Citadel Operating Doctrine v1.0 (effective 31 March 2026). Every finding is traceable to the audit; every fix to a phase, an owner and a done-when. This is a working document — revise it as the registry teaches you what the real matters are.

DOCUMENT	HORIZON	OWNER	IMPRINT
Implementation plan	16 Jul — 30 Sep 2026	Farhad Moinfar	Citadel · Lightspeed